

WINDS OF CHANGE
60 revolutions

IT INDUSTRY

Infosys®
celebrating
years



LEADING LIGHT: N.R. Narayana Murthy (fourth from left) with colleagues at Infosys

GIREESH GV

Digital ACCESS

A farmer can check the price of vegetables from a computer in his village, railway tickets can be booked at the click of a mouse and surgeries performed from across the world. Technology has changed life like never before.

■ By Kiran Karnik

The information technology (IT) sector perhaps best symbolises India's success. From a place in the world's top developing economies, to contributing a significant portion to India's GDP, to producing a whole new segment of highly specialised human capital, the progress of the IT sector has been phenomenal in the last two decades. It has been an exciting and ever-accelerating journey. IT has become India's biggest export. From mere providers of labour, we have traversed the distance to becoming the bedrock of the global IT industry.

The IT industry's roots were laid by the investment in education made as a part of the Nehruvian

legacy. The creation of institutions like the IITs installed a system that created talent and inculcated superior intelligence. The government's role was enormous when the industry was still nascent. A specific example is the creation of software technology parks of India (STPIs) or virtual software technology parks, with tax benefits. Such innovations erased the geographical constraints that IT faced initially. It was perhaps because of this that an Infosys could start from a small flat in Pune and an HCL from a small barsati in Delhi. It was not a utopian picture though, and there were a number of problems, like the US recession and the aftermath of 9/11 that made business difficult due to